

Monday, 27 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 26° 16°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 23° 15°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 19° 14°	GLASGOW Light drizzle 18° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Prime Minister Andy Burnham says he's prepared to challenge US President Trump if it's 'right for Britain'.

Speaking exclusively, Mr Burnham confirmed a positive first conversation with the US president. He emphasised the importance of defending the UK's national interests.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Police are investigating donations made by a company owned by Reform UK's deputy leader, Richard Tice.

Britain Means Business, the company in question, reportedly made two donations of £250,000 to Reform UK. These payments were made in the lead-up to the 2024 general election.

POLITICS · UK
- 3

A huge fire at industrial units on an Essex farm led to a dramatic explosion caught on camera.

Over 100 firefighters were dispatched to tackle the blaze on Friday. The incident saw an exploded barn rain down debris, described by one witness as 'like a movie'.

INCIDENT · UK
- 4

Residents evacuated due to a wildfire in the Cairngorms are now being allowed to return home.

Police Scotland had declared the fire a major incident on Friday, prompting the evacuations. Thankfully, the situation has now been brought under control and the declaration stood down.

ENVIRONMENT · UK
- 5

A wildfire on Tintwistle Moor has been burning for over a month and is now described as 'the size of a small town'.

Firefighters have been battling the extensive blaze for weeks, with no immediate end in sight. The sheer scale of the fire highlights the ongoing challenge for emergency services.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Ryan Gosling is set to join the Marvel Cinematic Universe, taking on the role of Ghost Rider.**

The surprise announcement came during San Diego Comic-Con. Gosling revealed that playing Ghost Rider is a character he has 'wanted to play for a very long time'.

ON AIR – What do we think of Ryan Gosling as Ghost Rider? Is he the perfect fit, or would you have picked someone else?

FILM · COMING UP
- 2 Actor Iwan Rheon says a new TV thriller about a heatwave will 'resonate in today's world'.**

Rheon, known for Game of Thrones, has been filming the new drama in Wales. He noted that the weather conditions during production were 'changeable' at best.

ON AIR – With the weather we've been having, a heatwave thriller sounds very timely! Do you enjoy dramas that reflect current events?

TV · COMING UP
- 3 Meghan, the Duchess of Sussex, made a guest judge appearance on MasterChef Australia, with a surprise video call from Prince Harry.**

During her time on the show, Meghan affectionately referred to Harry as 'a charmer'. The duke's unexpected call added a personal touch to her appearance.

ON AIR – Meghan on MasterChef – what a treat! Would you like to see more royals making appearances on popular TV shows?

TV · THIS WEEK
- 4 A collection of letters written by Morrissey before The Smiths found fame are going up for auction.**

The letters were sent to a Birmingham pen pal when the singer was between 14 and 20 years old. They offer a fascinating glimpse into his early life and thoughts.

ON AIR – Morrissey's early letters are being auctioned – what a piece of music history! If you could read anyone's teenage letters, who would it be?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 5 A pop band that once played for rescue dogs is now selling out arenas, discussing their journey to success.**

The group shared stories of disastrous early gigs and how they incorporate political action into their music. They also explored the meaning behind their 'queer pop' label.

ON AIR – From dogs to arenas – what an incredible journey! What's the most unusual place you've ever seen a band perform?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1

Lando Norris has secured his and McLaren's first Grand Prix victory of the year at the Hungarian Grand Prix.

It was a compelling race that saw the Briton take the top spot. This win marks a significant moment for both Norris and the McLaren team this season.

ON AIR – A fantastic win for Lando Norris! Do you think this could be the start of a strong run for him and McLaren this year?

F1 · UK

2

Anthony Joshua dramatically stopped Kristian Prenga in the second round, setting up a potential fight with Tyson Fury.

Joshua suffered two knockdowns early in his comeback fight in Saudi Arabia but recovered to secure the win. This victory clears the path for a highly anticipated super-fight.

ON AIR – Joshua took some big hits but came back to win! Who are you backing if he faces Tyson Fury next?

BOXING · UK

3

Gymnast Reuben Ward has gone from watching the Commonwealth Games as a boy to winning gold for Scotland in Glasgow.

Twelve years ago, Ward watched Dan Keatings win gold in his hometown. Now, he's celebrating achieving the same feat, fulfilling a childhood dream.

ON AIR – What an inspiring story! Have you ever achieved a dream you had as a child, or is there one you're still working towards?

GYMNASTICS · UK

4

Jos Buttler's explosive 90 off 50 balls helped Manchester Super Giants to a strong total in The Hundred.

Buttler's innings, which included five sixes, was key in reaching 187-5 against Birmingham Phoenix. Welsh Fire also had a winning start, with Rachin Ravindra starring.

ON AIR – Buttler was on fire in The Hundred! Are you enjoying the format this year, and who are you tipping to win?

CRICKET · UK

5

Jenny Shin held on to win the Women's Scottish Open, fending off fellow South Korean A-Lim Kim.

Shin navigated a tricky final round to secure the title. Her victory marks a significant achievement in one of golf's prestigious events.

ON AIR – A fantastic win for Jenny Shin in Scotland! Do you follow women's golf, and who are your favourite players?

GOLF · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that spending time looking at intricate details in nature, like the patterns on a butterfly wing, can boost our focus.**
Researchers found that even short periods of observing complex natural designs can improve concentration and reduce mental fatigue. It's a lovely excuse to get out and enjoy the garden!
- 2 The joy of 'analogue games', like classic board games and card games, is experiencing a charming revival.**
With so much digital distraction, people are rediscovering the simple pleasure of face-to-face interaction and strategy that these traditional games offer. Perfect for a family evening in!
- 3 Scientists are exploring how listening to 'natural ambient sounds', such as rustling leaves or gentle rain, can enhance relaxation.**
It seems our brains respond positively to these soothing soundscapes, helping to lower stress levels and improve overall wellbeing. Time to open a window, perhaps?
- 4 There's a growing trend for creating 'tiny art installations' in unexpected public places, bringing a touch of whimsy to daily life.**
From miniature sculptures nestled in tree roots to small painted rocks along pathways, these delightful surprises are making people smile and encouraging local creativity.
- 5 The simple act of 'cloud-gazing' is being highlighted as a wonderful way to spark imagination and mindfulness.**
Taking a moment to watch the ever-changing shapes in the sky can be surprisingly calming and a fantastic exercise for creative thinking. What shapes can you spot today?
- 6 Experts are suggesting that collecting 'found objects' on walks, like interesting pebbles or fallen leaves, can be a mindful activity.**
It encourages us to slow down, observe our surroundings more closely, and appreciate the small, natural treasures all around us. A lovely way to connect with nature.
- 7 The delightful art of 'origami', or paper folding, is gaining popularity as a relaxing and creative hobby.**
It's a fantastic way to develop dexterity and patience, transforming a simple piece of paper into something beautiful. Plus, all you need is a sheet of paper!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if it's going to be a good hair day, even though we know it makes no logical sense?

ANSWER: STICKING OUR HEAD OUT THE WINDOW FOR A 'WIND TEST'.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a nice, hot slice of toast. What is it?

ANSWER: FANNING IT VIGOROUSLY TO COOL IT DOWN, EVEN IF IT'S ALREADY COOL.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know those 'little everyday sounds' that are just pure comfort to you, almost like a sonic hug?**
Whether it's the gentle hum of the fridge, the distant purr of a cat, or the soft ticking of a clock, what's that everyday sound that instantly makes you feel cosy and at home?

- **We all have those 'unusual item combinations' that we absolutely love, even if others find them a bit peculiar!**
Perhaps it's a surprising flavour pairing in a sandwich, an odd dipping sauce choice, or a strange way you arrange your breakfast. What's your favourite, slightly eccentric, food combination?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** The 'Great Stink' in London in 1858 was so bad that Parliament had to suspend its sessions due to the overwhelming smell from the River Thames.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** During the construction of the London Underground, a lost badger once caused a six-month delay by building an elaborate tunnel system that mimicked the planned route.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.4 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.4 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of ferrets is known as a 'business'.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The average cloud weighs around 550 tons, roughly the same as 100 elephants.
- It is illegal to sing out of tune in Maryland, USA.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not.
- The world's oldest known living tree is Methuselah, a Bristlecone pine in California, estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.

On this day

Day 208 of the year, 157 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anthusa of Mantinea; Christian feast day: Aurelius and Natalia and companions of the Martyrs of Córdoba.; Christian feast day: Blessed Maria Maddalena Martinengo; Christian feast day: Maurus, Pantalemon, and Sergius. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1975 — Fred Mascherino, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1957 — Bill Engvall, American comedian, actor, and producer
- 1967 — Juliana Hatfield, American singer-songwriter and musician
- 1993 — Max Power, English footballer
- 1955 — Bobby Rondinelli, American drummer
- 1935 — Billy McCullough, Northern Irish footballer
- 1968 — Julian McMahon, Australian actor and producer (died 2025)
- 1967 — Neil Smith, English cricketer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1983 — Black July: Eighteen Tamil political prisoners at the Welikada high security prison in Colombo are massacred by Sinhalese prisoners, the second such massacre in two days.
- 1949 — Initial flight of the de Havilland Comet, the first jet-powered airliner.
- 1940 — The animated short A Wild Hare is released, introducing the character of Bugs Bunny.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1975 — Mayor of Jaffna and former MP Alfred Duraipappah is shot dead.
- 1997 — About 50 people are killed in the Si Zerrouk massacre in Algeria.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1955 — El Al Flight 402 is shot down by two fighter jets after straying into Bulgarian air space. All 58 people on board are killed.
- 1949 — Initial flight of the de Havilland Comet, the first jet-powered airliner.
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1983 — Black July: Eighteen Tamil political prisoners at the Welikada high security prison in Colombo are massacred by Sinhalese prisoners, the second such massacre in two days.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 209 of the year, 156 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alphonsa Muttathupadathu (Syro-Malabar Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Botvid; Christian feast day: Jaime Hilario Barbal; Christian feast day: Johann Sebastian Bach, George Frederick Handel, Henry Purcell (Episcopal Church commemoration). Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1948 — Gerald Casale, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and director
- 1951 — Gregg Giuffria, American rock musician and businessman
- 1992 — Spencer Boldman, American actor
- 1990 — Soulja Boy, American rapper, producer, and actor
- 1964 — Lori Loughlin, American actress
- 2000 — Emile Smith Rowe, English footballer
- 1949 — Randall Wallace, American screenwriter and producer
- 1962 — Rachel Sweet, American singer, television writer, and actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1996 — The remains of a prehistoric man are discovered near Kennewick, Washington. Such remains will be known as the Kennewick Man.
- 1945 — A U.S. Army B-25 bomber crashes into the 79th floor of the Empire State Building killing 14 and injuring 26.
- 2001 — Australian Ian Thorpe becomes the first swimmer to win six gold medals at a single World Championship meeting.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2018 — Australian Wendy Tuck becomes the first female skipper to win the Clipper Round the World Yacht Race.
- 1957 — Heavy rain and a mudslide in Isahaya, western Kyushu, Japan, kills 992.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 31 Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7 Once Upon a Time in a Cinema

FRI 14 Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie

FRI 21 Mutiny; The Bride!

FRI 28 Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4 Conjuring: Last Rites

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026

23 JUL — 2 AUG Commonwealth Games, Glasgow

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10 Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)

SAT 15 Premier League season begins (2026/27)

22–23 Belgian Grand Prix (F1)